

Incident Alert 0030. TLP CLEAR.			Date	Breakout Scale
Title	EU – Russian Sanctioned Entities Accessible to EU Audiences on Telegram		01/10/2024	2

Summary

- As of September 24th 2024, at least 37 accounts of Russian media entities and individuals sanctioned by the EU, posing as such, or consistently amplifying their content are accessible to EU audiences.
- The accounts have more than 7.7 million followers across the platforms.
- [Council Regulation No 269/2014](#) prohibits hosting content from these channels or making them available to EU audiences on social media platforms, as clarified in [Commission guidance](#) updated mid-May 2024.
- Accounts reported to Telegram. Telegram should address this seemingly systemic issue.

Incident

Despite EU sanctions against Russian media and specific prominent propagandists, as of late September 2024, Telegram still makes content produced by sanctioned Russian state-controlled media and sanctioned media personalities accessible to European audiences.

A widespread presence of sanctioned content and channels was recorded on Telegram, with large media channels easily accessible to EU audiences. Despite sanctions, these channels, some with millions of followers, remain accessible, showing no evident effort to restrict or block access to this content in the EU. These include:

- 26 sanctioned media entities' official channels,
- 11 personal channels of personalities specifically sanctioned by the EU (see Annex I of Council Regulation No 269/2014), including several with a large following.

This report is the fifth part of a larger project looking into social media companies' adherence to EU sanctions against Russian media and individuals ([1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#)).

Narrative

N/A

Impact

Reach: The identified accounts have around 7,770,000 followers (the EU share of which cannot be inferred from public data). The accessibility of these outlets is significantly higher than on any previously studied platform.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Facilitate State Propaganda](#) – Spread Russian operational content via Facebook.
[Conceal Network Identity](#) - channels owned by actors hiding their affiliation to the Russian state.

Recommendations

- Action taken: Case reported to Telegram (20/08/2024), and European Institutions, and EU member states (30/09/2024).
- Telegram should – take action to uphold the sanctions on the content and channels listed in this report, proactively look for content and actors similar to those listed in this report, and review all names on the EU sanctions list to ensure they do not have an EU-accessible presence on the platform.
- Telegram should ensure that the channels identified are not benefiting from revenue-sharing mechanisms which could run afoul of EU sanctions.
- We also recommend that civil society actors alert both platforms and authorities when they identify sanctioned accounts or content within the EU.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Content type	Platforms
Link	Sanctions, Russia	Upon request	Charles Terroille , Science Feedback Saman Nazari , A4E	Video, image, text.	Telegram